

What's Good About an Enterprise Cloud Security Governance Strategy?

In the first article in this series on cloud security, we highlighted the limitations of a traditional cloud security strategy in mitigating the cyber threats faced by modern enterprises and outlined the 'enterprise cloud security governance strategy', which is a more comprehensive approach. We will now explore the differences between these two strategies.

In many enterprises, confusion often arises regarding ownership and responsibility in the cloud, exacerbated by the shared responsibility model between the cloud service provider (CSP) and the enterprise. For instance, while the cloud security team may primarily focus on addressing cloud security misconfigurations, it may not have ownership of critical components such as the secured application pipeline, third-party APIs, Software as a Service (SaaS) applications, or network connections to on-premises or Active Directory. Despite the potential risk these components pose if compromised, stakeholders often assume that they fall outside the purview of the cloud environment and delegate their security to different teams. This lack of clarity poses a significant risk, as breaches in these areas can still serve as potential entry points for attackers, posing a significant threat to the entire cloud infrastructure. The fundamental distinction between a traditional 'cloud security strategy' and an 'enterprise cloud security governance strategy' lies in the approach to ownership and responsibility.

A 'cloud security strategy' typically dissects the different layers of the cloud and views them as separate areas of security within the enterprise. Responsibility is distributed among various teams with different roles, leading to obscurity



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regarding ownership in certain grey areas. Conversely, an 'enterprise cloud security governance strategy' takes an inclusive approach, encompassing any obscure areas within the enterprise digital landscape and ensuring that adequate mitigation measures are in place.

Through this comparative exploration, we aim to elucidate the pivotal role that enterprise cloud security strategies play in fortifying organisations against sophisticated cyber threats. These strategies ensure the integrity, confidentiality, and availability of critical assets in today's dynamic digital landscape and are essential for enhancing overall cyber resilience.

Comparing the differences

1. **Comparing the scope:** Here we compare the extent or boundaries to which cloud security measures apply in each strategy, encompassing the entirety of cloud-based systems, assets, and data.